



General Sailing Instructions for Royal Cork Yacht Club Keelboat Racing 2026

Racing Rules

1. All races shall be governed by the Racing Rules of Sailing (RRS), World Sailing (WS) Offshore Special Regulations (OSR) Appendix B as follows: "All races shall be governed by the Racing Rules of Sailing (RRS), Irish Sailing (IS) Prescriptions, World Sailing (WS) Offshore Special Regulations (OSR) Appendix B, the Notice of Race (NOR) and the Sailing Instructions (SIs) for any particular race or series, these Sailing Instructions (General SI's) and any amendments thereto. In addition, the following must be carried aboard and be in working order:
 - A fully operational marine VHF radio.
 - A fully operational inboard or outboard engine.
 - A first-aid kit and manual
 - An effective means to quickly disconnect or sever the standing rigging from the boat
2. Competitors in races for One Design classes shall also comply with their relevant Class Rules.
3. Competitors in IRC (International Rating Certificate) and Club handicap classes shall, in addition, comply with the rules of these handicapping systems.
4. IRC Rule 22.4 (Crew number/weight) shall not apply unless specified in the SI's or NOR for a specific event.

Entry and Eligibility

5. Except for Open events, only members who have submitted a completed and signed 'Keelboat Racing Entry and Declaration Form 2026', on-line, and who comply with all requirements on that declaration/form, may race and register results in RCYC leagues or events and be eligible to receive RCYC Trophies.
6. A valid IRC certificate is required to have a valid entry for IRC results.
7. A valid ECHO certificate is required to have a valid entry for ECHO results.
8. Any boat found not to comply with club rule 14, section 14.3 "**Guests & Visitors 14.3**. No Member shall introduce the same guest more than six times in one calendar year and no guest shall be introduced to the Club more than twelve times in the said calendar year" will be scored a DSQ without grounds for appeal.
9. Only Boats which satisfy the definition of "Cruiser" as per the [ICRA constitution](#) will be eligible to race in the ICRA classes, Any boat not meeting this definition shall race in the "Open Keelboats Classification" Class.

Notices to Competitors

10. Notices to competitors will be posted on the Official Club Notice Board which is located on the window of the Club Race office, the Royal Cork Keelboat Owners WhatsApp group, and/or on the Club website (Keelboat Noticeboard).

Changes to Sailing Instructions

11. Any change(s) to the SIs will be posted on the Official Notice Board not later than two hours before the scheduled start of the first race so affected.

Signals made Ashore

12. Signals made ashore will be displayed on the Club flag staff.
13. When flag AP is displayed ashore, '1 minute' is replaced with 'not less than 60 minutes' in the race signal AP.

Class Flags

14. Boats shall always fly the appropriate Class Flag while racing. Any boat not flying the correct pennant(s) may not be scored.
15. Boats shall show their correct sail number. Permission to race using any other sail number must be sought from the Race Committee prior to going afloat. Any boat not showing its correct sail number may not be scored.
16. The Race Committee & the Organising Authority reserves the right to place any boat in any class it deems appropriate.

Local Harbour Regulations

17. Use of the harbour is governed by the Port of Cork Byelaws and you are referred to the following relevant documents:
[Guidance notes for Leisure Craft](#)
[Port of Cork Byelaws 2016](#)
 - 17.1 All boats shall not impede Commercial Vessels navigating within the defined navigation channel.
 - 17.2 All boats shall keep at least 150 metres away from the Refinery Jetty or Vessels moored alongside.
 - 17.3 If found to have been in breach of item 17.1 and 17.2 above, a boat may be disqualified from the race or league or event in which they are competing in or at the time of the incident without grounds for appeal.
 - 17.4 Protests for infringement of 17.1 and 17.2 above can be initiated by any club member who is witness to the infringement or by the Race Committee, if informed of an infringement by the Port authorities. Note the protest time limit will not apply to infringements of 17.1 and 17.2 above.

Time Limits

18. For midweek races, Monday to Friday, May to August, the time limit is 2130hrs. This amends RRS 35.
19. For midweek races, Monday to Friday, September, the time limit is 2030hrs. This amends RRS 35.
20. For weekend races the default time limit is 4 hours and the time limit for all other boats will be 90 minutes after the first finisher. This amends RRS 35.
21. Individual races may prescribe different limits which will be in notice of race and override this time limit.

Marks/Courses

22. At the discretion of the Race Officer (RO) courses may be either
 - 22.1 Round the Cans selected from the current Royal Cork Keelboat Racing Course Card (note 2026 update). Each boat should have a copy.
 - 22.2 Courses specified by the RO using any combination of navigation marks, Port of Cork Laid Race Marks, RCYC racing marks and inflatable buoys
 - 22.3 Port of Cork Laid Race Marks are yellow cones permanently laid and may be in these approximate locations.

Dosco (Corkbeg)	51° 49.26' N	8° 15.81' W
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Ringabella	51° 46.24' N	8° 17.52' W
Harp	51° 47.19' N	8° 14.21' W
East Mark (Formerly Mark B)	51° 46.31' N	8° 14.18 W

Starting/Finishing

23. Races will be started by using RRS 26 with the warning signal made 5 minutes before the starting signal.
24. Boats whose warning signal has not been made shall keep clear of the starting area during the starting sequence for other races.
25. The order of starts will be at the RO's discretion and may be announced on the designated VHF channel.
26. A number of Start/ Finish lines may be used. These include:
 - 26.1 Grassy Walk Line (ICF 'G'). The starting line shall be formed by a Red & White pole in front of the hut at the Grassy Walk and an ODM. The ODM is Buoy C1 (Cage) Green Conical OR A LAID Club Mark. The finish line will be between the rearmost pole and the ODM or between the CV and the ODM.
 - 26.2 Committee Vessel (CV). The Start and Finish line will be formed between a Red and White staff on the CV and an Inflatable Buoy or Navigation Buoy as indicated by the CV.
 - 26.3 If the Race Officer is absent when a boat finishes, she should report to the Race committee her finishing time and her position in relation to nearby boats at the first reasonable opportunity.

Protests and Requests for Redress

27. In addition to RRS 60.2, persons intending to protest shall inform the RO immediately upon finishing or retiring of their intention to protest.
28. Protest forms are available from the Club office or Club bar.
29. For each class, the protest time limit is 60 minutes after the last boat in that class has finished the last race of the day or the race committee signals no more racing today, whichever is later.

Arbitration

30. RRS Appendix T – Arbitration Applies.

Scoring

31. The scoring system used for Keelboat racing leagues shall be the 'RRS Appendix A Low Point System' with the following amendments:

	Description	Penalty
DNC	Did Not Compete	Series Entry Plus One Place
DNS	Did Not Start	Series Entry Plus One Place
OCS	On Course Side	Race Entry Plus One Place
RET	Retired	Race Entry Plus One Place
DNF	Did Not Finish	Race Entry Plus One Place
RAF	Retired After Finishing	Race Entry Plus One Place
OOT	Out Of Time	Race Entry Plus One Place
DSQ	Disqualified	Series Entry Plus One Place

32. If four or more races are completed in a series, then one discard shall apply. If 6 or more races are completed in a series, then two discards shall apply. For the calculation of Super League results (the results of all Thursdays and all Fridays for the season, one discard shall apply for every 4 races completed).

Safety Regulations

33. A boat that retires from a race shall notify the RO as soon as possible.
34. All competitors must wear life jackets if the CV/PRO/RO displays Code Flag "Y".

Equipment and Measurement Checks

35. A boat or equipment may be inspected at any time for compliance with the class rules and sailing instructions.
36. On the water, a boat can be instructed by a race committee equipment inspector or measurer to proceed immediately to a designated area for inspection.
37. A boat may be disqualified from the series if found in breach of the Class rules or the Sailing Instructions.
38. Boat identification numbers (issued and recorded by Irish Sailing) shall be displayed on the Mainsail, Spinnaker, Gennakers, Code Zero or similar sails as prescribed by the IRC and RRS.
39. For White Sail (aka Non-Spinnaker) classes: only one headsail and one mainsail shall be flown at any one point in time, in addition Headsails may only be poled out using a whisker/or spinnaker pole set to windward.
40. No boat shall race with its anchor protruding forward of the bow.

Radio Communications

41. Except in an emergency, a boat shall neither make radio transmissions while racing nor receive radio communications not available to all competing boats. This restriction also applies to mobile telephones.
42. Courses may be announced on the designated VHF channels prior to starting sequence of that class. Typically, this will be channel 71 if not specified in the notice of race and, if different, will be posted on the RC blackboard before the start.

Prizes

43. Except for Open events, only members who have submitted their completed 'Keelboats Racing Entry and Declaration Form 2026' documentation and comply with all requirements on that Declaration may race in RCYC leagues or events and be eligible to receive results and RCYC Trophies.
44. Prize will be awarded at the discretion of the organising authority, it is the intention of the organising authority to award prizes as follows:

	Day	Prize	Handicap
Daily Prizes	Thursday Night Series	1st Spin ICRA Class 1 & 2*	IRC & Echo
		1st Non-Spin ICRA 1 & 2*	IRC & Echo
		All in***	Echo
		1st Open Keelboats Classification**	IRC & Echo
	Friday Night Series	Friday 1st Non-Spin Class 1 & 2***	Echo
	Saturday Coastal Series	Coastal 1st	IRC & Echo

Series Prizes

- Thursdays: 1st–3rd Open Classification** & ICRA Class 1&2*(IRC + Echo); 1st All-in (IRC & Echo).
- Fridays: 1st–3rd WS Echo (Class 1&2*).
- Saturdays: Coastal 1st–3rd IRC & Echo.

*The decision to award class 2 or subsequent division prizes will be made by the organising authority.

** The decision to award Open Classification prizes will be made by the organising authority.

*** All in IRC results will be published for information only, prizes maybe awarded at the discretion of the organising authority.

Disclaimer of Liability

45. Competitors participate in an event entirely at their own risk. See rule 4, Decision to Race. The organizing authority will not accept any liability for material damage or personal injury, or death sustained in conjunction with or prior to, during, or after the event.

Insurance

46. It is the duty of each boat owner to have their boat adequately insured against any risk, including civil responsibility to third parties and to ensure that such insurance remains valid for the entirety of the events sailed in.